MODULE 4: WRITING
(CO: 1)

Complete Study Textbook, Professional Writing Guide & VIT FAT Question Bank

Aligned with Official VIT BAENG101 Course Page Syllabus, Question Bank, and Past FAT Papers

Scope of This Textbook (Official VIT Syllabus - All 12 Topics): (1) Research Writing: Structure of a Review Paper, (2) Types of Reviews: Narrative, Systematic, and Meta-analysis, (3) Literature Review methodology and synthesis matrices, (4) Academic integrity and plagiarism avoidance, (5) Referencing Styles: IEEE Format, and (6) Referencing Styles: APA 7th Edition Format.

1 VIT FAT Exam Blueprint & Master Citation Sheet

Module 4 carries **20 marks** in BAENG101 FAT:

1. **Structure & Writing of a Review Paper (10 Marks):** Defining a review paper, explaining the step-by-step process of synthesizing literature, creating comparison matrices, and identifying research gaps.
2. **IEEE vs. APA Referencing Styles (10 Marks):** Converting raw source metadata into flawless in-text citations and end reference list entries for journal papers, books, conference proceedings, and websites.

Source Type	**IEEE Referencing Style (Numbered: [1])**	**APA 7th Edition (Author-Date: Smith, 2024)**
Journal Article	J. K. Author, "Title of paper," **Abbrev. Title of Periodical**, vol. x, no. x, pp. xxx–xxx, Month, Year, doi: xx.xxx.	Author, A. A., & Author, B. B. (Year). Title of article. **Title of Periodical**, **xx**(x), pp–pp. https://doi.org/xx.xxx
Book	A. B. Author, **Title of Book**, xth ed. City of Publisher, Country: Abbrev. Publisher, Year.	Author, A. A. (Year). **Title of book** (xth ed.). Publisher.
Conference Paper	C. D. Author, "Title of paper," in **Proc. Name of Conf.**, City, Country, Year, pp. xxx–xxx.	Author, A. A. (Year). Title of paper. In **Proceedings of the Name of Conference** (pp. xx–xx). Publisher.

2 Literature Review & Academic Synthesis

2.1 Narrative vs. Systematic Literature Reviews

- **Narrative Review:** Qualitative, broad overview of a subject area summarizing current consensus, historical developments, and emerging perspectives without a rigid predefined search protocol.
- **Systematic Review:** Highly structured, comprehensive, and transparent methodology utilizing strict inclusion/exclusion criteria, documented search queries (Boolean operators across Scopus/IEEE Xplore/ Web of Science), and PRISMA flowcharts to minimize bias.

2.2 Synthesizing Sources & Avoiding Plagiarism

A literature review is **not** a disconnected series of book reports. Effective academic writing synthesizes sources thematically using synthesis matrices:

- **Paraphrasing:** Re-expressing an author's original concept entirely in your own distinctive voice and sentence structure while faithfully retaining the underlying technical meaning.
- **Citation Mandate:** Always credit the original source with appropriate in-text citations ([1] in IEEE or (Smith, 2024) in APA).